CLARISSA H. TRENT

Email: trentcl@iu.edu Phone: (865) 585-7307

EDUCATION

Indiana University, Indianapolis
Master of Arts in Philanthropic Studies, expected May 2027

University of Tennessee, Knoxville
Bachelor of Arts in Anthropology, December 2024

- Minor in Museum & Curatorial Studies

EXPERIENCE

Lyric Opera of Chicago — Chicago, IL
Gift Planning Intern — June 2026 - August 2026

- Researched current Planned Givers and Estates to update information in the CRM.
- Conducted prospect research on Illinois-based Planned Givers to the MET Opera.
- Assisted on an open probate case to secure funding through researching donor contribution history.

Outer Cape Health Services — Provincetown, MA
Graduate Assistantship — August 2025 - May 2026

- Managed the social media presence to engage younger donors and re-engage lapsed donors.
- Worked on the structure and event schedule for the planned giving society.
- Conducted prospect research on potential and lapsed donors.
- Managed a portfolio of 30 prospects through email and calls.

21st Mortgage — Knoxville, TN
Financial Counselor — January 2025 - June 2025

- Managed over 200 accounts, navigating difficult conversations to assist customers with financial issues.
- Reviewed account bases to proactively problem-solve and move in line with local and federal laws.
- Researched accounts with external tools and internal departments to create meaningful contact.

University of Tennessee, Knoxville — Knoxville, TN
Student Assistant, German Department — August 2024 - December 2024

- Conducted qualitative research on the effects of the curriculum on students' learning outcomes and mental health
- Acted as a liaison between students and the professor to assist with issues.
- Led language tables to help with vocabulary and pronunciation practice.

Office Assistant, Housing Department — February 2024 - December 2024

- Provided general administrative support to the dormitory.
- Assisted students with dormitory conflicts and issues.
- Assisted in maintaining inventory of office supplies and housing materials.
- Managed the distribution of keys for a building of over 500 residents.

Knox Pride — Knoxville, TN
Development Intern — February 2024 - December 2024

- Identified and researched foundation support prospects for the Pride Museum project.
- Created a structure for a membership program to establish a museum philanthropic pipeline.

National Museum of Asian Art, Smithsonian Institution — Washington, DC
Advancement Intern — June 2024 - August 2024

- Conducted prospect research for event and leadership briefing materials.
- Inventoried exhibition catalogs for the Advancement office and established a tracking system.

- Drafted multi-channel annual fund campaign materials, including solicitation letters, email campaigns, social media posts, and a creative brief.
- Assisted stewardship and cultivation efforts through event support and drafted correspondence.

Emerson Collective Youth Collaborative, Smithsonian Institution: Leadership for Change — Washington, DC
Smithsonian Affiliations Intern — June 2023 - August 2023

- Competitive, donor-sponsored position to conduct and publish research
- Published blog posts on the history of transracial Asian adoption in the United States, along with conducting interviews with transracial Asian adoptees.
- Assisted with Smithsonian Affiliations newsletter production, distributed to museums across the country.
- Participated in donor stewardship, including meeting with donors and drafting impact materials.

McClung Museum of Natural History and Culture, University of Tennessee, Knoxville — Knoxville, TN
Development Intern — January 2023 - May 2023

- Planned and executed member stewardship and cultivation events.
- Audited donor and member records, ensuring donor-giving information is accurate.
- Assisted in the creation of the “Adopt-a-Painting” solicitation materials.
- Executed a mailed donor stewardship campaign on behalf of the museum director.

Delta Phi Lambda Sorority, Inc., UT Knoxville Chapter — Knoxville, TN
Vice President of Records — May 2024 - December 2024

- Organized and facilitated chapter meetings, ensuring agendas were followed, minutes were accurately recorded, and action items were addressed.
- Recorded and maintained a comprehensive log of all chapter events and activities, including attendance and outcomes, to support future planning and reporting.

Philanthropy and Fundraising Chair — December 2021 - December 2024

- Planned and executed fundraising events to benefit the Bone Health and Osteoporosis Foundation.
- Led realignment of local philanthropic partner to support sorority members’ values.

Vice President of Internal — May 2023 - May 2024

- Planned business retreats by establishing an itinerary and leading team bonding exercises.
- Ensured that all members adhered to the sorority’s bylaws and policies, acting as a mediator to resolve internal conflicts among members when needed.
- Audited chapter records to create a portfolio of chapter achievement and history to present to the 23 active chapters and the national executive board.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Microsoft Office Suite, Google Suite, Canva, WordPress, Clipchamp, Tessitura, PANDA, Donor Perfect, Bloomerang, iWave